

The God Who Showed Up

Chapter Reference Guide

For Paul & Pam's Review Before Writing Begins

This document lays out each chapter with its title, primary scripture, core theme, shadow application, connection to the Abrahamic promises, and the additional names that may be woven into each chapter's "For Further Study" section. Use this to confirm the order, identify anything that should be added or adjusted, and make notes before we begin writing.

Introduction: What's In A Name?

Primary Texts: Exodus 3:13–14 · Genesis 12:1–3 · Galatians 3:8, 16, 29 · Galatians 6:15–16 · 1 Corinthians 10:1–11 · Romans 2:28–29 · Romans 9:6–8

Purpose: Establish that God reveals His character through His names. Introduce the three Abrahamic promises as the driving force of the story. Build the Scriptural case that Israel's journey is the Christian's journey. Lay out the shadow framework. Invite the reader into the journey.

Status: Draft complete — ready for Paul & Pam's review.

Chapter 1: Elohim — The God Who Was Already There

Primary Text: Genesis 1:1

Core Theme: The very first name in Scripture. Before anything existed — before any crisis, any need, any human story — God was already there. Elohim is plural in form but used with singular verbs, pointing to something about God's nature that would not be fully revealed for centuries.

Shadow: Before your story began, before your crisis, before your need — God was already there.

Promise Thread: Elohim is the God who will later make the promises to Abraham. He is the starting point of everything — the promises, the journey, and the reader's own story.

Praying His Name: When you don't know where to start, start with the God who was there before the beginning.

Possible "For Further Study" Names: El Elyon — God Most High (Genesis 14:18–20) · El Olam — The Everlasting God (Genesis 21:33)

Notes/Questions for Review:

- This is the only chapter with no crisis — just creation. Does the chapter need any additional texture, or does the simplicity serve the arc well as a starting point?
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Chapter 2: Yahweh (YHWH) — The Self-Existent One

Primary Text: Exodus 3:13–15

Core Theme: Moses asks for a name. God gives him the name above all names: I AM WHO I AM. Not “I was” or “I will be” — I AM. Present tense. Eternal. Self-existent. Dependent on nothing and no one. This is the covenant name — the personal name of God, revealed at the moment of Israel’s deliverance.

Shadow: The God who called Moses to deliver Israel from bondage is the God who delivers us from the bondage of sin. The name He gave at the burning bush is the name He still answers to.

Promise Thread: The deliverance from Egypt is God keeping the promise He made to Abraham — “I will make you a great nation.” The nation was in bondage. Yahweh came to deliver them. The covenant name is revealed at the moment the covenant promise begins to be fulfilled.

Praying His Name: You are not praying to a concept. You are praying to I AM — the God who exists right now, in this moment, fully present.

Possible “For Further Study” Names: Jehovah Mekoddishkem — The Lord Who Sanctifies You (Exodus 31:13)

Notes/Questions for Review:

- The chronological order places Yahweh (Exodus 3) after Elohim (Genesis 1) but before El Roi (Genesis 16) and Jireh (Genesis 22). This is because we’re following the order of revelation to Israel as a people — the burning bush is where God formally reveals His covenant name through Moses. El Roi and Jireh were revealed to individuals earlier in Genesis, but Yahweh is the name that launches the national story. Does this ordering feel right, or would you prefer strict chronological order?

Chapter 3: El Roi — The God Who Sees

Primary Text: Genesis 16:7–14

Core Theme: Hagar — a slave woman, pregnant, alone, cast out, not part of the covenant. By every human measure, invisible. And God shows up. She is the first person in Scripture to give God a name: “You are a God who sees.” That the first person to name God is a foreign slave woman matters enormously.

Shadow: Every person who has felt unseen, overlooked, forgotten, or invisible needs to hear this name. Nobody is invisible to God.

Promise Thread: Hagar’s story happens because of the promise — Abraham and Sarah’s attempt to fulfill the promise through human means. Even in the mess created by human impatience with God’s timing, God sees and provides. The promise is not derailed by human failure.

Praying His Name: When you feel like no one sees you, no one knows what you’re carrying, no one understands — pray to El Roi. He saw Hagar in the wilderness, and He sees you.

Notes/Questions for Review:

- Hagar’s story connects powerfully to the theme of the invisible and the outcast. Any additional cross-references you want brought in?

Chapter 4: Jehovah Jireh — The Lord Will Provide

Primary Text: Genesis 22:1–14

Core Theme: The mountain. The knife. The impossible command. And at the last moment — provision. Abraham names the place: “The Lord Will Provide.” Not past tense. Not present. Future — a statement of faith for every trial that hasn’t happened yet.

Shadow: Every Christian will face a mountain where obedience seems to cost everything. Jireh is the name that says: trust Him. He sees what you cannot, and He provides what you do not have.

Promise Thread: This is the crisis point of the promise. God asks Abraham to sacrifice Isaac — the son of the promise, the only means by which “a great nation” could come. Abraham’s obedience and God’s provision on that mountain are the moment the promise survives its greatest threat. Hebrews 11:17–19 adds that Abraham reasoned God could raise the dead — the promise was that certain to him.

Praying His Name: When you cannot see how the need will be met, when obedience feels costly, pray to Jehovah Jireh. The God who provided the ram provides still.

Notes/Questions for Review:

- The typology of Isaac and Christ is strong here (the only son, the mountain, the wood carried, the substitute provided). How deeply do you want to press that in the chapter itself versus saving it for cross-references?

Chapter 5: El Shaddai — God Almighty

Primary Text: Genesis 17:1–8

Core Theme: God appears to a 99-year-old man with a barren wife and says: “I am God Almighty. Walk before Me and be blameless.” Then He changes Abram’s name to Abraham — father of a multitude — before there is a single child. El Shaddai is the God for whom nothing is too hard.

Shadow: When the promise seems dead, when the years have passed, when the math doesn’t work — El Shaddai is the name that says: My power is not limited by your circumstances.

Promise Thread: This is the direct fulfillment moment for the first promise. God has waited until the situation is humanly impossible — Abraham is 99, Sarah is 90 — and then says “I am God Almighty” and reaffirms the promise. The impossibility is the point.

Praying His Name: When you have waited so long that hope feels foolish, pray to El Shaddai. He specializes in the impossible.

Notes/Questions for Review:

- The etymology of “Shaddai” is debated (possibly related to “mountain” or “breast/nourisher” or “almighty/overpowerer”). Worth noting the debate briefly, or simply go with “God Almighty” as the NASB renders it and focus on the context?
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Chapter 6: Jehovah Rapha — The Lord Who Heals

Primary Text: Exodus 15:22–27

Core Theme: Three days out of Egypt. No water. They finally find water and it's bitter. God shows Moses a tree, Moses throws it in the water, the water becomes sweet. Then God reveals the name: "I am the Lord who heals you." The first name revealed in the wilderness — and it comes at the first crisis after deliverance.

Shadow: The bitterness of the world — disappointment, pain, loss — is real. But God does not leave us in it. He heals. Not always the way we expect, but always.

Promise Thread: They are on the road to the Promised Land. The second promise — "to your descendants I will give this land" — is driving the journey. Every wilderness name is revealed on that road. Rapha is the first provision for the journey.

Praying His Name: When life turns bitter — when the thing you hoped for is not what you found — pray to Jehovah Rapha. He makes bitter waters sweet.

Notes/Questions for Review:

- The healing here is of water, not a person — God's healing is broader than physical. Worth emphasizing that Rapha encompasses spiritual, emotional, and relational healing as well.
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Chapter 7: Jehovah Nissi — The Lord Is My Banner

Primary Text: Exodus 17:8–16

Core Theme: Israel's first battle after leaving Egypt. Moses holds up his hands and Israel prevails. His hands drop and Amalek prevails. Aaron and Hur hold up his hands. Israel wins. Moses builds an altar: "The Lord Is My Banner." The victory was never Moses' strength — it was God's. And God used the community around Moses to sustain it.

Shadow: The victory is never ours alone. The battle is the Lord's. And He often uses the people around us to hold us up when we cannot stand on our own.

Promise Thread: Amalek is the first enemy that tries to stop Israel on the road to the Promised Land. The battle is over the promise — will they reach the land God swore to give them? Nissi is the name that says: the enemy cannot stop what God has promised.

Praying His Name: When the battle is real and your arms are tired, pray to Jehovah Nissi. He is your banner — and He sends people to hold you up.

Possible "For Further Study" Names: Jehovah Sabaoth — The Lord of Hosts (1 Samuel 1:3, Isaiah 6:3)

Notes/Questions for Review:

- The theme of community (Aaron and Hur) is strong here and connects naturally to the church. Worth developing.
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Chapter 8: Jehovah Shalom — The Lord Is Peace

Primary Text: Judges 6:11–24

Core Theme: Israel is oppressed by Midian. Gideon is hiding in a winepress, threshing wheat in secret. The angel of the Lord calls him “mighty warrior” — which he clearly is not. Yet. Gideon is terrified he has seen God and will die. God says: “Peace to you. Do not fear; you shall not die.” Gideon builds an altar: “The Lord Is Peace.”

Shadow: God calls us what we are becoming, not what we are. And when we are afraid, His name is Peace — not the absence of conflict, but the presence of God in the middle of it.

Promise Thread: By the time of the Judges, Israel is in the land — the second promise is partially fulfilled — but they are not living in the fullness of it. They are in cycles of rebellion and oppression. Shalom is the name that says: even when you have failed, even when the consequences are real, God’s peace is still available.

Praying His Name: When fear has you hiding, when you feel unqualified, when the enemy feels bigger than you — pray to Jehovah Shalom. Peace is not a feeling. It’s a Person.

Possible “For Further Study” Names: Sar Shalom — Prince of Peace (Isaiah 9:6)

Notes/Questions for Review:

- Gideon’s story is rich — the fleece, the reduction of the army, the torches and trumpets. How much of the full Gideon narrative do you want in this chapter versus keeping it focused on the altar-naming moment?
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Chapter 9: Jehovah Rohi — The Lord Is My Shepherd

Primary Text: Psalm 23:1–6

Core Theme: Written by a man who was himself a shepherd and knew exactly what the metaphor meant. A shepherd provides, protects, guides, corrects, and stays with the sheep — even through the valley of the shadow of death. This name is personal: “The Lord is my shepherd.” Not Israel’s shepherd in general. Mine.

Shadow: Every Christian is a sheep — dependent, prone to wander, in need of a guide. Rohi is the name that says: He is not managing you from a distance. He is walking with you.

Promise Thread: David writes as king — the nation promise fulfilled. But even from the throne, David sees himself as a sheep. The king of Israel calls God his shepherd. The promises fulfilled do not eliminate the need for daily dependence on God.

Praying His Name: When you don’t know where to go, when the path is dark, when you feel lost — pray to Jehovah Rohi. He leads. You follow. That’s enough.

Possible “For Further Study” Names: Jehovah Raah — The Lord My Shepherd (alternate form)

Notes/Questions for Review:

- This chapter connects directly to Through the Valley. Any specific tie-ins you want made?

- Jesus' declaration "I am the Good Shepherd" (John 10:11, 14) is the New Testament fulfillment. How prominently should that feature?
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Chapter 10: Jehovah Tsidkenu — The Lord Our Righteousness

Primary Text: Jeremiah 23:5–6

Core Theme: Spoken during one of Israel's darkest periods — corrupt kings, false prophets, impending exile. God promises a coming King who will reign wisely and execute justice, and His name will be "The Lord Our Righteousness." Not our own righteousness. His. Given to us.

Shadow: Every attempt to stand before God on our own merit fails. This name points forward to Christ, who became our righteousness (2 Corinthians 5:21).

Promise Thread: The exile is the moment when all three promises appear to be failing — the nation is scattered, the land is lost, the blessing seems revoked. Tsidkenu is the name that says: God is not finished. A righteous King is coming. The promises are not dead — they are pointing forward.

Praying His Name: When your failures feel disqualifying, when guilt says you can't approach God, pray to Jehovah Tsidkenu. His righteousness is what qualifies you — not yours.

Notes/Questions for Review:

- The Messianic thread is strongest here. This name is almost entirely forward-looking — it points to Christ more directly than any other name in the book except Immanuel.
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Chapter 11: Jehovah Shammah — The Lord Is There

Primary Text: Ezekiel 48:35

Core Theme: After 48 chapters of judgment, exile, dry bones, and restoration — the final word of Ezekiel's prophecy is a name. "The name of the city from that day shall be: The Lord Is There." After everything — the sin, the exile, the destruction of the temple — God's final word is not judgment. It is presence.

Shadow: No matter how far you have wandered, no matter how much has been lost, no matter how long the exile — He is there. That is the last word. Not judgment. Presence.

Promise Thread: The exile threatened to erase every promise. The nation was scattered. The land was taken. The blessing seemed cursed. And God's answer, through Ezekiel, is a city whose name means "The Lord Is There." The promises survive because God's presence survives. He does not leave.

Praying His Name: When you feel like you've gone too far, when the exile feels permanent, when you wonder if God has left — pray to Jehovah Shammah. He is there. He has always been there.

Possible "For Further Study" Names: Attiq Yomin — Ancient of Days (Daniel 7:9)

Notes/Questions for Review:

- This chapter connects directly to Through the Valley as well — presence in the darkest place.

Chapter 12: Immanuel — God With Us

Primary Text: Isaiah 7:14 / Matthew 1:22–23

Core Theme: Promised by Isaiah to a faithless king. Fulfilled in a manger in Bethlehem. Every name in the Old Testament revealed something about God’s character from a distance — His power, His provision, His peace, His healing. This name closes the distance entirely. Immanuel does not mean “God sees us” or “God provides for us.” It means “God with us.” He came.

Shadow: The entire Old Testament points to this moment. Every name was a preview. Immanuel is the fulfillment — God did not just show up in a crisis. He moved in permanently.

Promise Thread: Immanuel is the fulfillment of the third promise — “in you all the families of the earth will be blessed.” Abraham’s seed, through whom all nations are blessed, is Christ (Galatians 3:16). The seed has come. The promise is fulfilled. And the fulfillment is not a program or a system — it is a Person. God with us.

Praying His Name: You are never praying across a distance. Immanuel means He is here — with you, in you, beside you. Every name you have learned in this book is now as close as your next breath.

Possible “For Further Study” Names: El Gibbor — Mighty God (Isaiah 9:6) · Abba — Father (Mark 14:36, Romans 8:15) · Alpha and Omega — The Beginning and the End (Revelation 1:8, 21:6, 22:13)

Notes/Questions for Review:

- This is the culmination chapter. It should feel like arrival — everything the book has been building toward lands here.
- How much of the Isaiah 7 historical context (Ahaz, the Syro-Ephraimite crisis) do you want before moving to the Matthew fulfillment?

Conclusion: He Is Still Showing Up

Primary Texts: Matthew 27:51 · Hebrews 10:19–22 · Psalm 50:15 · Romans 10:13

Core Theme: The veil is torn. From top to bottom — from God’s side reaching down. Every name in the book was revealed through a separation. After Eden, access was limited. The veil said “this far and no further.” When Jesus died, God tore it. The barrier is removed. Every name is now accessible not through a priest, a temple, or a veil, but through Jesus directly. He is still showing up — and because of the torn veil, we can now show up too.

Connection to A New and Living Way: This conclusion lands in the same place the prayer book begins — the torn veil, the open door, the invitation to draw near. The God Who Showed Up teaches who you are praying to. A New and Living Way teaches how to pray. The two books are companions.

Additional Names for “For Further Study” Sections

These names will not receive full chapters but should be referenced within the relevant chapters:

Name	Meaning	Key Text	Likely Chapter
El Elyon	God Most High	Genesis 14:18–20	Ch 1 (Elohim)
El Olam	The Everlasting God	Genesis 21:33	Ch 1 (Elohim)
Jehovah Mekoddishkem	The Lord Who Sanctifies	Exodus 31:13	Ch 2 (Yahweh)
Jehovah Sabaoth	The Lord of Hosts	1 Sam 1:3, Isa 6:3	Ch 7 (Nissi)
Jehovah Raah	The Lord My Shepherd	Psalm 23	Ch 9 (Rohi)
El Gibbor	Mighty God	Isaiah 9:6	Ch 12 (Immanuel)
Sar Shalom	Prince of Peace	Isaiah 9:6	Ch 8 (Shalom)
Attiq Yomin	Ancient of Days	Daniel 7:9	Ch 11 (Shammah)
Abba	Father	Mark 14:36, Rom 8:15	Ch 12 (Immanuel)
Alpha and Omega	Beginning and End	Rev 1:8, 21:6, 22:13	Ch 12 (Immanuel)

Open Questions for Paul & Pam

1. Chapter ordering — Yahweh (Exodus 3) is placed before El Roi (Genesis 16) and Jireh (Genesis 22) because the covenant name launches the national story, even though El Roi and Jireh appear earlier in Genesis chronologically. Does this ordering serve the narrative, or would you prefer strict chronological order?
2. Additional names — Are there any names you want elevated to full chapters, or any full chapters you’d prefer to move to “For Further Study” status?
3. The Conclusion — It currently mirrors and connects to A New and Living Way through the torn veil and Hebrews 10:19–22. Any additional elements you want in the conclusion?
4. Cross-references to other NobleMind books — How explicit do you want the connections to Through the Valley, Bridge Moments, The Character No One Could Invent, and A New and Living Way to be within the chapters themselves?
5. Anything missing? — Any themes, passages, or connections you’ve been thinking about that aren’t captured here?